

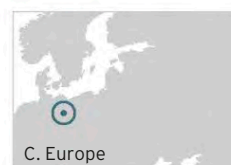


Brandenburg Gate

An imposing, monumental structure that provides a ceremonial focus for the city of Berlin

In 1788, Frederick the Great of Prussia ordered his architect Carl Gotthard Langhans (1732–1808) to build a monumental gateway in Berlin's city wall. In line with 18th-century German taste for ancient Greek culture, the design imitated the propylaeum (monumental gateway) at the Acropolis in Athens (see pp.98–99). Completed in 1791, the structure has six massive Doric columns on each side. Prussian sculptor Johann Gottfried Schadow (1764–1850) created the Quadriga—a four-horsed chariot with the goddess of peace—placed atop the gate in 1793.

The Brandenburg Gate has had a stormy history. The Quadriga was stolen by the French Emperor Napoleon in 1806 but returned after France's defeat in 1814. The gate was badly damaged in World War II and then became a central feature of the wall dividing Berlin from 1961 to 1989. Restored to its former glory, it now symbolizes German reunification.



▽ THE QUADRIGA

The Quadriga was originally built with a statue of Eirene, the Roman goddess of peace, driving the chariot. She was replaced by Victoria, goddess of victory, after Prussia defeated France in 1814.

